

NYC Bodega Elevated

The most democratic food institution in New York City. Made properly.

30	\$28	20%	\$14.5K
SEATS	AVG SPEND	FOOD COST	EST. MONTHLY NET

// WHAT A MICHELIN-TRAINED CHEF SEES IN THE NYC BODEGA FORMAT

The bodega is the most honest food institution in New York City. Open at 5am. Feeds everyone. No pretension. The bacon egg and cheese on a Kaiser roll is one of the most technically interesting sandwiches in American food — the egg folded just so, the cheese melted through with steam from the flat-top, the roll toasted on the same surface. It takes 4 minutes and requires a specific sequence that every bodega worker learns by feel. Elevating that format means respecting the original: keeping the speed, the value, the accessibility — and improving ingredient quality and technique without losing the soul. The chopped cheese is not a burger. Do not make it into a burger.

// WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

The bodega elevated concept works because it takes a format that New Yorkers trust emotionally and adds the execution quality the original format never had resources for. The café Bustelo cortadito at \$3.99 costs under \$0.50 to make. The banana pudding at \$8.99 with an 8% food cost closes the ticket. The \$28 average spend in a 30-seat room with minimal labour produces margins that most full-service restaurants cannot match.

This guide shows you how to run it.

SECTION 1 — ENTRÉES

Dish	Ticket	Price	FC%
Bacon Egg & Cheese — Brioche Roll	5 min	\$9.99	18%

Avocado Toast — Everything Bagel	5 min	\$10.99	15%
Elote Cup — Street Corn	4 min	\$6.99	11%
Chicken Soup — Abuela Style	5 min	\$8.99	14%
Loaded Fries — Cheese Sauce, Jalapeño	7 min	\$8.99	13%
Tostones — Fried Plantain, Garlic Mojo	6 min	\$7.99	10%

Bacon Egg & Cheese

Bacon Egg & Cheese — Brioche Roll

5 min ticket · FC: 18% · \$9.99 · SIGNATURE

Ingredient	Qty	Cost
Brioche roll, halved	1	\$0.60
Eggs, cracked flat	2	\$0.70
American cheese slice	2	\$0.25
Bacon strips, cooked	3	\$0.90
Butter, salt, pepper	10g	\$0.10

\$2.55 **\$9.99** **25.5%** **\$7.44**

FOOD COSTMENU PRICEFC %GROSS PROFIT

- 1 Toast brioche cut-side down on flat-top with butter. 90 seconds. Move to corner of grill to keep warm.
- 2 Crack eggs directly onto flat-top at **180°C**. Break yolks. Fold into rectangle roughly the size of the roll. Season.
- 3 Lay cheese slices over egg. Cover with dome or foil for 30 seconds to melt through with steam. Do not skip this step — the steam melt is the technique.
- 4 Add bacon to bottom bun. Slide egg-cheese stack on top. Close. Wrap in foil for 20 seconds — it steams further and holds together. Serve immediately.

The foil wrap is the bodega secret. It steams everything together and means the customer gets it hot even if they walk out. 20 seconds in foil = better sandwich.

SECTION 2 — MAINS

Dish	Price	FC%	Note
Chopped Cheese — Bodega Classic	\$14.99	19%	Signature
Italian Hero — Mortadella, Provolone	\$13.99	18%	
Breakfast Burrito — Egg, Potato, Chorizo	\$12.99	17%	
Pastrami on Rye — Deli Mustard	\$15.99	20%	
Chicken Cutlet Parm Sub	\$13.99	19%	
Jerk Chicken Rice Bowl	\$13.99	20%	

Birria Quesadilla — Consommé Dip	\$14.99	21%	Signature
Bodega Salad — Chopped, House Dressing	\$11.99	12%	
Macaroni Salad — House	\$8.99	9%	
Big Breakfast Plate	\$14.99	20%	Signature

Chopped Cheese

Chopped Cheese — Bodega Classic

8 min ticket · FC: 19% · \$14.99 · SIGNATURE

Ingredient	Qty	Cost
Ground beef (80/20)	180g	\$1.40
American cheese slices	3	\$0.38
Hero roll (hoagie)	1	\$0.55
Onion, diced	40g	\$0.08
Ketchup, mayo, mustard	to taste	\$0.15
Shredded lettuce, tomato	30g / 2 slices	\$0.25

- 1 Cook onions on flat-top until soft. Add beef, season. Cook breaking apart with spatula. When nearly done, chop repeatedly with spatula — you're creating a crumbled, chopped texture, not a patty.
- 2 Lay cheese slices over meat. Cover with dome 30 seconds to melt completely into the meat mixture.
- 3 Toast hero roll on flat-top. Sauce bottom half (ketchup, mayo). Add meat-cheese mixture. Top with lettuce and tomato. Wrap tight in foil.

The chopping motion is essential. It combines the beef, onion and cheese into one unified filling. A burger patty on a roll is not a chopped cheese. The texture is the identity.

Birria Quesadilla + Consommé

Birria Quesadilla — Consommé Dip

10 min ticket · FC: 21% · \$14.99 · SIGNATURE

Ingredient	Qty	Cost
Beef birria (braised chuck, chiles)	150g	\$1.80
Consommé (birria braising liquid)	120ml	\$0.40

Flour tortillas2 large\$0.30

Oaxacan cheese, shredded60g\$0.90

White onion + cilantro, fine chop20g each\$0.15

1Birria prep (batch, day before): Braise beef chuck with guajillo, ancho, pasilla chiles, tomato, onion, garlic, cumin, oregano at 160°C for 4 hours. Pull meat, strain braising liquid (this is the consommé).

2To order: dip tortilla in consommé fat layer. Place on hot flat-top. Add cheese, birria meat, onion-cilantro. Fold, press. Cook 2 min each side until crispy and cheese melts through.

3Serve with ramekin of hot consommé for dipping. Dip, eat, repeat.

The consommé dip is the dish. Without it, it's a quesadilla. With it, it's an experience. Keep the consommé hot and well-seasoned — it gets tasted and it gets Instagrammed.

SECTION 3 — DESSERTS

Dish	Price	FC%
Flan — Caramel, Vanilla	\$7.99	10%
Tres Leches Cake	\$7.99	12%
Churros — Dulce de Leche	\$7.99	11%
Bodega Banana Pudding	\$8.99	8%

Banana pudding at \$8.99 with 8% FC (\$0.72 cost) is the best margin dessert in this guide. Make it in large batches. Nilla wafers, banana, vanilla custard — unmistakably New York.

SECTION 4 — DRINKS

Café Bustelo — Cortadito

\$3.99 · Cuban espresso, condensed milk

Mango Juice — Jumex

\$2.99

Malta India

\$2.99 · Non-alcoholic malt

Horchata

\$4.99 · Rice, cinnamon, vanilla

Agua Fresca — Hibiscus

\$3.99

Bodega Smoothie

\$5.99 · Mango, banana, OJ

Brooklyn Lager

\$6.99

Iced Coffee — Sweetened

\$3.99

\$0.48 \$3.99 12% \$3.51

CORTADITO FC SELL PRICE FC% GROSS PROFIT

SECTION 5 — SERVICE TRAINING

SCRIPT 01 — WELCOME

"The food is bodega. The technique isn't. Everything here is made from scratch — the cheese sauce, the consommé, the flan. Same energy, different standard. The chopped cheese and the BEC are the moves."

SCRIPT 02 — CHOPPED CHEESE

"The chopped cheese is chopped on the flat-top — beef, onion, American cheese melted through, ketchup, mayo on a hero roll. It's a New York thing. You won't find it outside the five boroughs. We do it right."

SCRIPT 03 — BIRRIA QUESADILLA

"The birria is beef braised in chiles for 4 hours. The consommé on the side is the braising liquid. You dip the quesadilla in, eat it, repeat. The dip is the whole point."

SCRIPT 04 — CAFÉ BUSTELO CORTADITO

"The cortadito is Cuban espresso with sweetened condensed milk. \$3.99. Stronger than anything at Starbucks. It's how the bodega opens every morning in New York."

SCRIPT 05 — RETURN VISIT

"The big breakfast plate on weekends — two eggs, meat of your choice, toast, home fries. Different energy. Same quality. Come back Saturday."

SECTION 6 — DAILY PREP SCHEDULE

Time	Task	Who
06:00	Open, BEC station ready, flat-top on	Opener
07:00	Breakfast rush — BEC, cortadito, smoothies	FOH + Chef
09:00	Lunch prep: birria consommé on, chorizo cooked	Chef
10:30	Flan sets, banana pudding assembled	Chef
11:30	Lunch service starts	All
15:00	Afternoon — restock, batch cook for next day	Chef
20:00	Close, stock check	Closer

SECTION 7 — P&L MODEL

Revenue	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
Food Sales	\$980	\$5,880	\$25,480
Beverage	\$280	\$1,680	\$7,280
Total	\$1,260	\$7,560	\$32,760

Cost	%	Monthly
Food Cost	20%	\$6,552
Labour	30%	\$9,828
Overheads	15%	\$4,914
NET PROFIT	35%	\$11,466

30-seat bodega with minimal kitchen equipment and lean labour. The cortadito alone — 40 cups/day at \$3.51 profit each — generates \$140/day in coffee margin. That's \$4,200/month from one item.

SECTION 8 — SAFETY & ALLERGENS

Temperature Control

Item	Hold Temp	Max Hold
Birria beef + consommé	Above 65°C or below 3°C	4 days refrigerated
Flan (set)	Below 3°C	3 days
Banana pudding	Below 3°C	2 days
Chopped cheese (cooked)	Serve immediately	No hold — cook to order

Allergen Matrix

Dish	Allergens
Bacon Egg & Cheese	GlutenEggsDairy
Chopped Cheese	GlutenDairy
Avocado Toast	Gluten
Pastrami on Rye	Gluten
Chicken Cutlet Parm Sub	GlutenEggs
Flan	DairyEggs
Tres Leches	GlutenDairyEggs
Banana Pudding	GlutenDairyEggs